AARAMBH

WCE HACKATHON 2026

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK & PARTICIPANT GUIDELINES

Event Date: Thursday, 8 October 2026
Event Start: 8:00 AM onwards
Venue: Walchand College of Engineering, Sangli

This rulebook consolidates the participation requirements, registration policy, competition structure, evaluation criteria, code of conduct, and hardware requirements applicable to the Aarambh WCE Hackathon. Every participant is expected to read this document in full before registering.

1. Event Overview

Aarambh WCE Hackathon is a technical innovation and problem-solving competition. Participants identify practical challenges, develop technology-based solutions, build prototypes, and demonstrate their implementation before a jury.

- **Event Date:** Thursday, 8 October 2026
- **Starting Time:** 8:00 AM onwards
- **Venue:** Walchand College of Engineering, Sangli (WCE)

2. Team Composition & Registration Capacity

Team Size

- **Each team must consist of exactly 5 participants.**
- **No team may consist entirely of boys or entirely of girls — at least 1 girl or at least 1 boy, respectively, must be present in every team.**

Gender Requirement

- **Every team must include at least 1 male and at least 1 female participant.**
- **All-male teams and all-female teams are not permitted.**

College & Leadership

- All team members must belong to the same recognized college/institution in India.
- Mixed-college teams are not permitted.
- Each team must nominate one Team Leader as the official point of contact, responsible for communication with the organizing committee and for relaying instructions to the rest of the team.

3. Eligibility — Who Can Participate?

- B.Tech and B.E. students from recognized engineering colleges in India.
- Students of any academic year from Walchand College of Engineering, Sangli.

Not eligible: Ph.D. research scholars, industry professionals, and faculty members are not permitted to participate. Only currently enrolled B.Tech/B.E. students, as described above, may register.

Participants must provide accurate information about their academic status during registration. The same-college team requirement applies to all teams.

4. Problem Statement Selection

- Each team must select exactly one problem statement from the official catalogue.
- The problem statement is assigned/confirmed only after successful registration and payment verification.
- **Once confirmed, the problem statement cannot be changed, exchanged, or transferred.**
- Teams must work only on their assigned problem statement for the entire event and may not switch to another statement mid-competition.

5. Registration & Payment Policy

Registration is completed in three simple steps:

1. **Step 1 — Register:** Submit your team details through the official registration form. This reserves your spot *provisionally*, not permanently.
2. **Step 2 — Pay:** Complete the registration fee payment as instructed on the registration platform.
3. **Step 3 — Verification & Confirmation:** The organizing committee verifies the payment. Once verified, your team's registration is officially confirmed and a confirmation email is normally sent within 24 hours.

A provisional reservation is not the same as confirmation — only a verified payment secures your team's spot.

Partial, fraudulent, manipulated, duplicated, or otherwise invalid payment claims will result in immediate cancellation or disqualification of the registration.

6. Competition Structure & Shortlisting

The competition is conducted in two progressive rounds. Teams are shortlisted at each stage based on evaluation performance, and the organizing committee's decision on shortlisting is final.

Round 1 — Online PPT, Pitching & Preliminary Shortlisting

- Round 1 will be conducted online on 5th and 6th October 2026.
- Teams will deliver their PPT presentation, pitch their proposed solution, and present a prototype to the jury online.
- Software category teams must also present a short prototype of their solution.
- Hardware category teams must also explain the circuit simulation of their solution.
- The presentation should clearly cover the problem, proposed solution, innovation, methodology, technical approach, hardware/software requirements, and expected outcome.
- **Teams must strictly use the PPT template/format provided by the organizing committee for their presentation.**
- Based on the evaluation in this round, elimination will be done, the slots for Round 2 will be decided, and the shortlisted teams will advance to Round 2.

Round 2 — Offline Pitching & Prototype Presentation

- Round 2 will be conducted offline at Walchand College of Engineering, Sangli on 8th and 9th October 2026.
- Shortlisted teams present their proposed solution to the jury, with a functional short prototype wherever applicable.
- Evaluation covers problem understanding, technical approach, innovation, feasibility, prototype functionality, implementation plan, and pitching quality.
- Based on the pitching and prototype presentation, elimination will be done.

7. Evaluation & Jury

- All team members must be present for scheduled jury evaluations on the designated Thursday and Friday event days, unless an exception is approved by the organizers.
- Evaluation considers experimental accuracy, methodology, prototype/implementation quality, documentation quality, technical understanding, and viva responses.
- The jury may also weigh innovation, feasibility, practical applicability, and quality of demonstration.
- **Jury decisions are final and binding.** No appeal against the final jury decision will be entertained.
- Final scores and results are announced on Friday during the prize-distribution ceremony.

8. Selected Technical Domains

Problem statements are grouped under eight technical domains. Each domain contains one or more problem statements, and eligible teams choose one statement from the official catalogue within their preferred domain.

- Smart Cities & Urbanization
- Healthcare & Medical Technology
- EV & Mobility
- Education & Academic Learning
- Renewable Energy & Power Systems
- Aerospace, Aviation & Space Technology
- Cybersecurity & Digital Forensics
- Agriculture & Aquaculture

9. Fair Play & Code of Conduct

All participants are expected to maintain a respectful, inclusive, professional, and harassment-free environment throughout the event.

Expected Behaviour

- Treat all participants, organizers, volunteers, mentors, jury members, faculty, and staff with respect.
- Do not deliberately interfere with another team's participation, equipment, workspace, or evaluation.
- Follow reasonable instructions issued by organizers for safety, venue management, and fair conduct.

Reporting & Consequences

- If you witness or experience inappropriate conduct, report it promptly to the event organizers or designated event staff.
- Confirmed serious misconduct may result in removal from the event and/or disqualification of the team.

10. Academic Integrity & Malpractice

In simple terms: do your own work, and be honest about it.

- Present only your own team's work. Do not copy another team's solution or claim someone else's work as your own.
- Do not fabricate or falsify experimental results or data.
- Do not accept unauthorized help during evaluation.
- Do not tamper with another team's prototype.
- Do not submit fraudulent documents or false information.
- You may use legitimate third-party libraries, open-source tools, documentation, APIs, datasets, or frameworks — but you must be able to explain how you used them, and you must not present third-party work as your own.

Any confirmed malpractice may result in immediate disqualification of the team.

11. Hardware & Component Policy

- Prepare approximately 30–40% of the hardware/components your project needs in advance, depending on your problem statement, and bring backup or extra components wherever practical.
- If your project needs a specific, specialized, uncommon, or externally sourced component, arrange and bring it yourself.
- Ensure your hardware is compatible with your proposed solution.
- Follow all electrical and laboratory safety instructions while using hardware at the venue. Unsafe, damaged, or unsuitable equipment must not be connected to the venue's electrical supply.

12. Participant Responsibilities

- Maintain a backup of important project files and code.
- Bring required and specialized hardware/components.
- Maintain cleanliness and order in the assigned workspace.
- Handle electrical/electronic equipment responsibly.
- Respect venue property and other teams' equipment.
- Follow all safety, security, schedule, and organizer instructions.
- Ensure every team member understands the project and can explain its technical implementation.

13. Refund & Cancellation Policy

- **No refunds will be provided once registration has been confirmed.**
- **No refund will be provided if a registered participant/team fails to attend the event.**
- **No refund will be provided for voluntary withdrawal after registration confirmation.**
- **Registration cannot be cancelled after confirmation.**
- **The confirmed problem statement cannot be changed after registration confirmation.**
- **If the event is rescheduled, the registration fee remains non-refundable under this policy.** Any revised date or major operational update will be communicated through official organizer channels.

End of Official Rulebook